

Tutorial 3 - Bitcoin Across Venues: Spot, ETFs, Futures, and Options

Learn which market is speaking, when it speaks, and why that matters.

Session anchor: April 23, 2026 session: Bitcoin spot, IBIT / ETF cash, options, CME futures, and timing around the U.S. open.

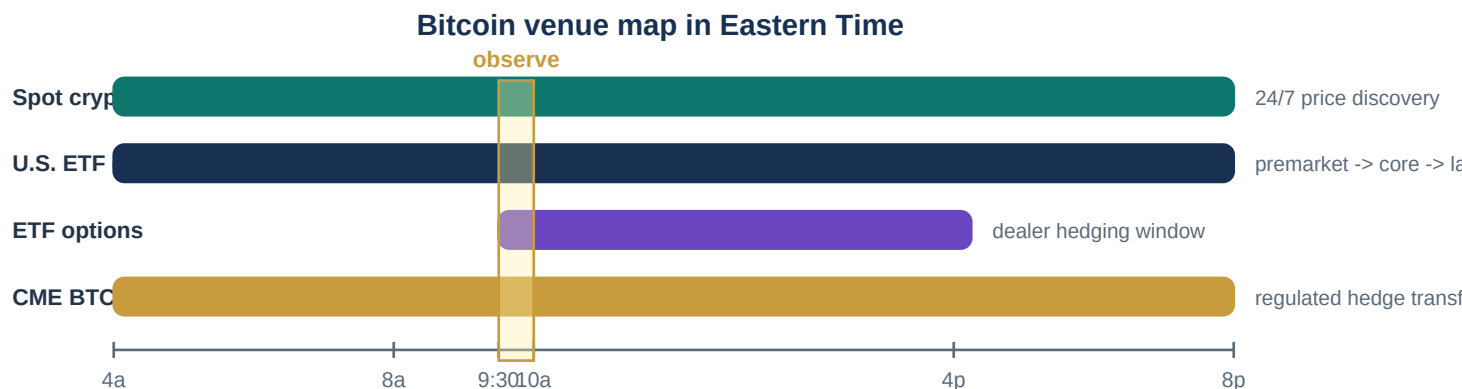
Audience	Students who currently read only one Bitcoin chart and miss how venue structure changes the signal.
Last updated	April 23, 2026
External depth	Official exchange and SEC documents added to the venue map and timing framework.

What students should be able to do after this tutorial

- Name the main Bitcoin-linked venues a U.S.-hours trader should monitor.
- Explain what spot, ETF cash, ETF options, and CME futures each add to price discovery.
- Use market hours to decide when to observe and when to act.
- Build a pre-open checklist that compares venue behavior instead of staring at a single chart.

Core coaching principle

The session phrased it well: you cannot time the market, but you can time market participation. For Bitcoin, participation changes by venue, not only by candle pattern.



1. Why one Bitcoin chart is not enough

The coaching session correctly pushed the student away from a single-chart mindset. Bitcoin is not just a spot asset anymore. It trades through crypto spot venues, U.S.-listed spot-Bitcoin ETFs, options on those ETF products, and regulated CME futures and options. Each venue has different participants, different hours, and different reasons for trading.

That means the student's job is not to ask, "What is Bitcoin doing?" The better question is, "Which venue is leading right now, and what kind of participant is likely behind that move?"

2. The venue map students should memorize

Venue	Typical hours / structure	What it tends to tell you
Spot crypto exchanges	24/7	Immediate risk appetite, weekend moves, and continuous price discovery
U.S. ETF cash market	Premarket / core / late U.S. equity sessions	How the U.S. cash-equity crowd is pricing Bitcoin exposure
ETF options	Regular U.S. options session, often with a 4:15 p.m. ET close	Dealer hedging pressure, strike magnets, and sentiment around cash products
CME Bitcoin futures and options	Regulated derivatives hours with clearing and margin structure	Institutional hedging, basis behavior, and formal risk transfer
Important market-structure update As of April 23, 2026, CME still documents regular Bitcoin futures and options trading hours on Globex with a daily maintenance break, but CME has also announced planned 24/7 cryptocurrency futures and options trading beginning May 29, 2026, pending regulatory review.		

3. External-source depth the original session did not have

NYSE publishes a clear U.S. equity session map: pre-opening starts at 6:30 a.m. ET on many venues, core trading is 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. ET, and late trading often runs to 8:00 p.m. ET. That matters because ETF cash participation grows around those windows.

Cboe publishes regular U.S. options hours for C1 options from 9:30 a.m. to 4:15 p.m. ET, with a curb session after that. CME documents current Bitcoin futures and options hours as Sunday-Friday 6:00 p.m. to 5:00 p.m. ET with a daily break. And SEC exchange filings now confirm that multiple spot-Bitcoin ETF products have listed options in the U.S., including IBIT and several peers. Students should learn this as a venue ecosystem, not as one generic "Bitcoin market."

4. A step-by-step pre-open workflow

Step 1 - Start with spot and futures context

Before the U.S. cash open, check what happened overnight in spot and CME-linked markets. Was the move orderly, headline-driven, or violent? Did it happen during liquid hours or thin hours?

Step 2 - Mark the U.S. open as an observation window

The coaching session warned the student not to gamble at 9:30 a.m. ET. Keep that. From 9:30 to 10:00, the student should observe how ETF cash and ETF options participation interact with the existing overnight move.

Step 3 - Compare venue agreement or disagreement

If spot, ETF cash, options flow, and CME all point in the same direction, the move is cleaner. If they disagree, the student should assume the market is still auctioning for control.

Step 4 - Only then ask about trade direction

A direction chosen after venue comparison is better than a direction chosen because one candle looked exciting.

5. The morning checklist students should actually use

Question	Why it matters
What did spot do overnight?	Tells you the raw 24/7 move before U.S. cash participation
Did the U.S. cash-equity open confirm or fade that move?	Shows whether ETF buyers and sellers agree with the overnight market
Are option strikes attracting price?	Helps you notice hedging pressure and likely magnets around popular ETF products
Is CME basis calm or stressed?	Adds a regulated derivatives read on positioning and risk transfer
Is this the first 30 minutes after the open?	If yes, observe first and avoid forced trades
Cleanup for students	
The session used the phrase "Chicago Board of Options" loosely. Teach the precise modern structure instead: U.S. options trade across listed options exchanges, and spot-Bitcoin ETF options are now listed on multiple exchange venues under SEC-supervised rules.	

6. Common mistakes

Mistake 1: Treating the ETF price as if it were the same thing as global spot. Correction: separate venue from underlying.

Mistake 2: Chasing the 9:30 a.m. ET candle. Correction: observe the open, then act only after participation becomes clearer.

Mistake 3: Reading options only as "bullish" or "bearish." Correction: use options to ask where hedging and strike gravity may matter.

Mistake 4: Ignoring futures because crypto trades 24/7. Correction: CME still matters because it is a regulated risk-transfer venue with its own participants and margin structure.

7. Student assignment

For five sessions, keep a venue journal with four columns: spot, ETF cash, ETF options, and CME futures. Before 10:00 a.m. ET, write one sentence per column explaining what that venue is saying.

After the close, write whether the venues were aligned, conflicting, or sequential. Over time, students should notice that some days are cash-led, some are derivatives-led, and some are just noisy auctions.

Selected external sources used in this tutorial

1. NYSE Trading Information - session structure and core hours - <https://www.nyse.com/trade/trading-information>
2. Cboe U.S. Options Hours - regular and curb hours - <https://www.cboe.com/about/hours/us-options/>
3. CME Bitcoin futures and options trading hours - <https://www.cmegroup.com/trading/bitcoin-futures.html>
4. CME press release - planned 24/7 crypto futures and options trading - https://www.cmegroup.com/media-room/press-releases/2026/2/19/cme_group_to_launch247cryptocurrencyfuturesandoptionstradingonma.html
5. SEC exchange filing showing listed options on multiple spot-Bitcoin ETF products - <https://www.sec.gov/files/rules/sro/miax/2026/34-105220.pdf>